Ross King

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Physicist and research manager with more than 25 years in applied computer science research, and co-founder of Iknaio. Heads the Data Science & Artificial Intelligence Competence Unit at AIT Austrian Institute of Technology, a multinational team of more than 50 researchers with an annual budget of about 8 M€. In 2015, together with Bernhard Haslhofer, initiated the GraphSense cryptoasset analytics research at AIT, which grew into the open-source platform that Iknaio builds on today. Coordinated the projects that funded this work (BITCRIME, TITANIUM, Anti-FinTer) and co-authored Iknaio's original business plan. Trained as an experimental particle physicist at Stanford University and the Stanford Linear Accelerator Center (SLAC).

Key Achievements

- **Co-founding Iknaio** – Co-authored the original business plan in 2021, founding investor, and advisor on strategy, research, and public funding.
- **Origin of GraphSense** – Coordinated the FFG KIRAS project **BITCRIME** (2014–2017), which started the development of the open-source GraphSense cryptoasset analytics software, and the H2020 project **TITANIUM** (2017–2020), which turned it into a toolset for law enforcement investigating virtual-currency transactions in darknet markets.
- **Security research for law enforcement** – Coordinated the ISFP project **Anti-FinTer** (2022–2023) on terrorist financing via the dark web and crypto-assets, in which GraphSense was used to train cryptocurrency investigators, and the German-Austrian video-forensics project FLORIDA for the Austrian counter-terrorism authority.
- **Research leadership** – Built AIT's data science group from a single research studio (2002) to a 50+ person competence unit; AIT Thematic Coordinator for Data Science; IPMA Level C certified project manager.
- **Community and governance** – Chairman of the Board of the Open Preservation Foundation (2013–2017); coordinator of the EU FP7 project SCAPE; member of the Big Data Value Association; program chair of iPRES 2014.
- **Voice on AI and crypto-assets** – More than 60 invited talks to law enforcement, public administration, and industry.

Professional Experience

2021 – Present	**Co-Founder & Advisor**, *Iknaio Cryptoasset Analytics GmbH, Vienna*. Original business plan, founding investor, strategic and research advice.
2020 – Present	**Head of Competence Unit Data Science & Artificial Intelligence**, *AIT Austrian Institute of Technology, Center for Digital Safety & Security, Vienna*. Research strategy, project portfolio, business development, budgeting and controlling for a team of 50+ researchers.
2008 – 2020	**Scientist** → **Senior Scientist**, *AIT Austrian Institute of Technology, Digital Safety & Security, Vienna*. Built and led the data science group (20+ researchers, 2.8 M€/year, independent profit centre 2009–2017); AIT Thematic Coordinator for Data Science; coordinator of SCAPE, BITCRIME, TITANIUM, FLORIDA, and Anti-FinTer.

2002 – 2007	**Scientist**, *Austrian Research Centers, Research Studios, Vienna*. Built up the Research Studio Digital Memory Engineering from one to 14 researchers; proposals, controlling, and commercial sales; boards of the FP6 Integrated Projects BRICKS and Planets.
2000 – 2002	**Technical Director**, *uma information technology AG*; **Senior Manager**, *Alpha Thinx Mobile Phone Services AG*, Vienna.
1995 – 2000	**Scientific Associate**, *Institute for Medium Energy Physics, Austrian Academy of Sciences, Vienna*. Head of the electronics laboratory; CCD detector for an exotic-atom experiment.
1989 – 1994	**Research Assistant**, *Stanford Linear Accelerator Center (SLAC)*. Polarimetry, data acquisition, and Monte Carlo simulation for the SLD experiment.

Education

1995	**Ph.D. in Physics**, *Stanford University*. Thesis: "A precise measurement of the left-right asymmetry of Z-boson production".
1988	**B.S. in Engineering Physics**, *Colorado School of Mines*. Graduated with highest honours.

Selected Projects

2024 – 2026	**KnowHow** (Project Lead), *BMEIA / FFG*. AI-enabled knowledge management.
2022 – 2023	**Anti-FinTer** (Coordinator), *EU ISFP*. Terrorist financing and crypto-assets.
2017 – 2020	**TITANIUM** (Coordinator), *EU H2020*. Darknet-market cryptocurrency forensics.
2016 – 2019	**FLORIDA** (Coordinator), *FFG KIRAS*. Mass-video forensics for terrorism cases.
2014 – 2017	**BITCRIME** (Coordinator), *FFG KIRAS*. Virtual currencies and financial crime.

Selected Talks

2023	**The Anti-FinTer Toolbox and Crypto-Asset Investigations**, *NSC Counter Ransomware Initiative, Illicit Finance Working Group*.
2022	**GraphSense: Open-Source Cryptocurrency Forensics**, *NSC Counter Ransomware Initiative, Illicit Finance Working Group*.
2021	**Dark Web and Cryptoasset Analytics**, *CERIS workshop on money laundering, European Commission, Brussels*.
2018	**TITANIUM: Early Results and Outlook**, *European Police Congress, Berlin*.

Selected Publications

1. **King, R.**, Kioumourtzis, G., & Papadopoulos, G. (2022). Countering terrorist financing. *ERCIM News*, 129, 9–10.
2. Schindler, A., Lindley, A., Naghibzadeh-Jalali, A., Boyer, M., Gordea, S., & **King, R.** (2020). Multimodal video forensic platform for investigating post-terrorist attack scenarios. In *Proceedings of the 11th ACM Multimedia Systems Conference (MMSys)*.
3. Haslhofer, B., Jochum, W., **King, R.**, Sadilek, C., & Schellner, K. (2009). The LEMO annotation framework. *International Journal on Digital Libraries*, 10(1), 15–32.
4. Schmidt, R., Sadilek, C., & **King, R.** (2009). A service for data-intensive computations on virtual clusters. In *First International Conference on Intensive Applications and Services*. IEEE. *Best Paper Award*.